upsilon

PRODUCT DESIGN / REDESIGN CASE STUDY

Fundraising is hard. Finding the right fit shouldn't be.

Find. Figure. Fund.

A clearer way for founders and investors to meet with intent, context, and visible reasons.

SCOPE Brand direction / Landing page / Founder match flow / Investor discovery

A responsive concept; sample profiles and match data are illustrative.

01 / AUDIT

What a new visitor has to figure out.

A heuristic desk review of the public homepage at upsilonbyaks.com, using the content and structure available on 20 Oct 2026. The notes below are observed design concerns, not measured conversion problems.

HEURISTIC FINDING	WHY IT MATTERS	PUBLIC-PAGE EVIDENCE
01 Promise competes with feature breadth	A time-poor visitor needs one clear outcome and next step.	Homepage introduces matching, grants, profiles, dashboards and deal rooms across the page.
02 Shared entry for two different jobs	Founders seek focus and credibility; investors seek control and signal.	Role-specific journeys appear after shared positioning and feature content.
03 AI score needs an explanation	An unexplained score can read as false precision.	AI relevance and fit criteria are promoted, but the result's interpretation is not immediately clear.
04 Social proof lacks decision context	Trust depends on what is verified, recent and relevant.	Network profiles and founder stories have limited visible cues for verification and freshness.
05 Discovery is not a funding promise	Financial decisions need honest boundaries between discovery and funding.	Matching, fundraising progress and deal-room outcomes sit near one another without a prominent caveat.
06 Long page weakens scan points	Small-screen and assistive-technology users need clear structure and orientation.	Network, dashboards, matching, deal rooms, FAQs and features form a lengthy sequence; full accessibility audit remains open.

EVIDENCE NOTE / The case-study web page includes annotated reconstructions of the reviewed page areas, not captured screenshots. Original screenshot capture and a complete accessibility audit remain outstanding validation work.

Source: upsilonbyaks.com. Review basis: public homepage copy and hierarchy; private analytics and user interviews were not available.

02 / REVIEW

Founders need focus. Investors need current evidence.

The personas below are design hypotheses, not interview findings. They create a testable starting point for the two entry paths.

FOUNDER / JOB STORY

When I am preparing a round with limited time and network, I want a short list of investors that fit my stage and thesis, with visible reasons and next steps, so I can make informed introductions without sending the same pitch everywhere.

INVESTOR / JOB STORY

When deal flow exceeds my capacity, I want teams aligned with my stated criteria and signals about what is current or missing, so I can decide whether to take a closer look without being pushed into a conversation.

WHAT THE DESIGN ASSUMES

Founders need a focused path to relevant investors and honest expectations. Investors need a quick read of thesis fit and the provenance of profile details. Both should remain in control of whether an introduction happens.

BRAND DIRECTION / Considered, clear, and quietly distinctive.

The three-point mark joins founder context and investor intent at the point of introduction. The web prototype and this PDF use Lora for editorial headings and Open Sans for clear interface reading. The official font files are embedded for consistent rendering.

Midnight
#1B293F
Primary text

Navy
#1B2D49
Primary action

Vermilion
#B94E3B
Action accent

Warm paper
#F7F4EC
Neutral canvas

CORE CONTRAST PAIR	RATIO	USE
Midnight #1B293F / Paper #F7F4EC	13.31:1 · AAA	Body + headlines
White / Navy #1B2D49	13.83:1 · AAA	Primary button
Slate #566276 / Paper #F7F4EC	5.61:1 · AA	Secondary copy

Contrast values are calculated for the stated hex pairs; review all rendered states and text sizes before production.

03 / REVIEW

The redesign makes fit legible.

The landing page names a concrete founder outcome, separates the two audiences, and lets the match flow show its work before asking anyone to connect.

LANDING / One promise, two doors

A direct founder CTA and a distinct investor entry replace a generic platform journey. The page explains how the product works in three steps.

FOUNDER MATCH / Evidence before labels

Stage, sector, geography and cheque overlap appear as explicit signals. Thesis freshness and the limits of a fit label stay visible.

INVESTOR DISCOVERY / Context before contact

Investor criteria sit alongside founder opportunities. Founder-reported information is identified for independent review.

FOUNDER PROFILE / Progressive disclosure

Four short steps collect company context, raise details, preferences and a review, with privacy language close to sensitive fields.

BEFORE AFTER

BEFORE	DESIGN RESPONSE
Many product claims compete for attention.	One clear outcome leads; features follow a short explanation of the journey.
Both audiences enter through a broad shared pitch.	Founder and investor paths each name a different job and action.
Score and AI language feel opaque.	Four visible fit signals plus a plain-language limitation note.
Discovery language sits near fundraising outcomes.	Mutual interest is framed as an introduction, never a promise of capital.

04 / REVIEW

A small system carries the same signals.

The landing page and product flows share a compact starter system: clear hierarchy, deliberate color roles, direct actions and reason-first cards.

COMPONENT	DEFAULT	INTERACTION / STATE	ROLE
Primary button	Navy fill, white text	Hover lift; disabled state shown	Commit / continue
Secondary button	White fill, line border	Visible focus ring on fields	Explore / edit
Text input	Label above; helper below	Focus border and halo	Progressive profile
Match card	Fit + signals + freshness	Save state; prototype CTA	Explain the why
Tags	Neutral filters / status	Selected state with border	Scan + refine

WHAT I WOULD VALIDATE NEXT

Talk with 2–3 founders and 2–3 investors / Ask what proof they need before trusting a suggested match; test whether the visible reasons change that confidence.

Confirm the introduction consent model / Define exactly what an introduction request sends, whose interest is visible, and how a user can pause or withdraw.

Verify profile provenance and freshness / Agree which information is verified, what is founder-reported, and how often investor criteria are refreshed.

Audit accessibility in a real prototype / Check keyboard order, screen-reader labels, zoom, color contrast and touch targets across desktop and mobile.

AI USE / AI assisted public-page research synthesis, copy drafting and front-end implementation. No interviews, private product analytics, live investor data or actual matching backend were used for this concept.

Explore the responsive prototype in index.html. Founder matches, investor profiles, scores and dates are illustrative; the introduction action is a prototype interaction and sends no message.